

World History





About the Course

One of the most powerful truths that history can teach us is that the past was different from the present. The way things are now is not the way they have always been, which should make us aware of the likelihood that the way things are now is not how they will be. The study of world history exposes students to what life was like in different places and at different times. As students read about people and events from 1800-1900 through history spines, historical novels, and primary source documents, they will get a better picture of the way people viewed the world, the challenges they faced, and the legacy they left behind. Students will also view images, reference maps, and work on their Book of Centuries as part of their lessons.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.), History: Grades 7-8 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for Grade 9. However, Grade 9 does include a term of lessons on historical thinking skills, which should not be skipped. So if combining 9th graders in this course, be sure to have them read that book next year.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	World History: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	Eiffel's Tower for Young People In the Shadow of the Alamo

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 U.S. History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 U.S. History: Grades 7-8	
History: Grades 7-8 (Canada)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 Canadian History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 Canadian History: Grades 7-8	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

World History: Grades 7-8



Eiffel's Tower for Young People



In the Shadow of the Alamo



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



World History: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any necessary links.
- If you have not read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.
- Decide which lessons/books to read together and which to have students read independently.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Have students give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If the previous passage is difficult to remember, teachers may ask a leading question: "What can you tell me about..." Or students may try looking back at any chapter/section headings or illustrations or reading the first paragraph to jog the memory.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson (often included in lesson plans).
- If necessary, talk about a few unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently. Sometimes reading for the specified time is a better guide.
- If a book is challenging, try stopping to narrate every now and then rather than waiting until the end. It can also help to read aloud. Or you might want to use an audiobook version of the text and have students read along with it.
- Have students keep an eye out for events or characters to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, or Copywork Book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or write a narration.
- Alternatively, students might analyze a character, trace cause to consequence, outline a passage, or use one of the other methods indicated by Charlotte Mason in School Education Chapter 16, especially p.180.
- Students who enjoy writing can experiment with different types of written narrations, but this is not required.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made (orally or in writing).

- You could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question to stimulate discussion. Discussion questions are often included in the lesson plans.



Connect

- Optional: Add something to the Book of Centuries, Century Chart, Citizenship Notebook, or Commonplace book. If students would like to include pictures, these may be drawn or printed.

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Los Soldados, A Terrible Mistake

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ INTRO

This is an historical fiction book that takes place in 1835-1836. This genre of book allows you to walk in the shoes of the soldiers of Mexico who were forced to fight the Americans at the Battle of Alamo. As you read you will see Spanish terms in italics. You can find the meaning of those words at the back of the book.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find Guanajuato which is located in central Mexico, about 130 miles northwest of Mexico City. How would you describe the terrain of this area?

Lorenzo lives in this village.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-part of ch.2, p.1-14 Beginning-"frown on her face."

- How would you describe Lorenzo so far?

→ VIEW

The predominant religion of Mexico is Roman Catholicism. Our Lady of Guadalupe holds a special place in the religious life of Mexico and is one of the most popular religious devotions. Her image, of a woman of mixed Indigenous and European features wearing a turquoise-colored mantle surrounded by a sunburst, has played an important role as a national symbol of Mexico.

∞ Image Link: Virgin of Guadalupe

• DEFINITIONS

conscrip: (p.6) enrolled into service by compulsion : drafted

dragoon: (p.7) mounted soldiers that fought both on horseback and on foot

WEEK 2 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

A Terrible Mistake, Following the Eagle

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

What is happening so far in the book?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.2-beginning of ch.3 p.14-28 "We did not" - "Something peaceful."

- What do you think about the idea of allowing a man's family to travel with him in war?
- How would you prove your age? Why was it hard for Lorenzo to prove he was only fifteen.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: General Antonio López de Santa Anna

WEEK 3 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Following the Eagle, The Deserters

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the crude comment on p.34 made by Bernardo.

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

Finish ch.3-beginning of ch.4 p.28-42 "I have played" - "happen, again, sir."

- What were some reasons men would desert the army?

WEEK 4 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

The Deserts, A Thing of the Past

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.4-ch.5 p.42-59 "Lieutenant Ochoa shouted" - "that haughty Esteban?"

- Why do you think the punishments were so severe for deserters?

WEEK 5 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

El Presidio

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find San Luis Potosí. How would you describe the terrain of this area?

Lorenzo visits this village with his fellow conscripts.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.60-75 "On the fourth" - "soldiers shut up."

- How did Lorenzo feel at the idea of visiting another village outside of his own?

• DEFINITIONS

peons: (pg.60) person of low social status or a laborer with no skills

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a description of a woman's body on p. 62 you might want to preview.

WEEK 6 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

El Presidio, El Presidente

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.6-ch.7p.75-90 "Return to your" - "to be there."

- How does Lorenzo view education? How does El Presidente view music? What do their views tell you about what's important to Lorenzo and El Presidente?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is an implication on pg. 89 that you might want to preview.

WEEK 7 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

El Presidente, The Importance of Goats

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ INTRO

Lorenzo and Estaban find themselves in a tricky situation. As you read through this section, think about how many people went through similar situations to Lorenzo. What would you do if you were accused of something and no one was listening to you?

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish Ch.7- ch. 8 p.90-103

- Why does Lorenzo change his mind about the importance of goats?

WEEK 8 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

A Rumor of War, Feliz Navidad

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find Saltillo and Coahuila on the map.

Lorenzo and the rest of the army pack up to head to these towns.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 -Start of ch.10 p.104-120. -"this pace last?"

- What celebrations does Lorenzo and the rest of the army join in? Discuss what these celebrations look like? How does everyone react to news about the war?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a situation that you might want to preview on pg. 109.

WEEK 9 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Feliz Navidad, The General's Orders, La Llorona

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→ INTRO

Three Kings Day, or as it called Epiphany celebrates the day the three wise men encounter the Baby Jesus and bring him gifts. It's also the day that many kids get their presents. Epiphany or Three Kings Day is celebrated all over the world and it's traditions differ from people group to people group.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.10-start of ch. 12 p.120-135 "On Christmas Eve" - "in their hands."

- How do Lorenzo's Christmas traditions differ from your own? Are you familiar with any of his traditions?

WEEK 10 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

La Llorona, White Death

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.12 -start of ch.13, p.135-150 "For over a" - "step for step."

- La Llorona is an urban legend in Lorenzo's culture. What are some urban legends you are familiar with?

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

WEEK 11 ☐ 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

White Death, Tejas

📄 Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.13- start of ch.14 p.150-166 "For February 13" - "sage-covered plain."

- How does Lorenzo deal with the loss of his family members?

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a situation that you might want to preview on pg. 160

WEEK 12 ☐ 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.

QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: IN THE SHADOW OF THE ALAMO

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Tejas, San Antonio de Bèxar

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.14-ch.15 p.166-180 "We marched along" - "help us all."

- What is surprising about this part of Lorenzo's journey?

WEEK 2 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Dawn at the Alamo

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

Note: Due to the graphic description of the aftermath of the war, we are skipping several sections. Please note the page numbers that are listed.

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- 1.Ch.16 p.181-190,
- 2.selection of ch.17 197-200 "In what seemed" - "this behind you."
- 3.selection of ch.17 p.203-207 "I began searching" - end.

- What surprised you in the reading?

WEEK 3 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

A Small Affair, A Quiet Death

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Skip the beginning of ch.18 Begin at p.214-229 "Suddenly I saw" - "end."

- What could have been different if General Santa Anna waited for reinforcements?

WEEK 4 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

The Advance

Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Mexico

Find San Antonio

Lorenzo says, "As we marched past the ruins of the Alamo, my heart ached. Here we had fought a vain and pointless battle and lost the flower of our army for no cause other than the egotism of His Excellency." Lorenzo and the rest of his unit would have fought in what is now San Antonio, Texas.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Due to sensitive content students will skip from pg. 242 to 252.

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 20 p.230-242 end - "on it's prow"

- Discussion Question Idea

WEEK 5 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Toward Destiny, San Jacinto

📖 Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21-start of ch. 22 p.252-262 "Early in the morning" - "men were doomed."

- Why were the soldiers taken by surprise?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Due to sensitive content students will skip from pg. 242 to 252.

WEEK 6 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

San Jacinto, Home

📖 Materials: In the Shadow of the Alamo

→RECAP

Tell briefly what you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch. 22-23 p.262-280 "That night the" - end of book.

- Why did Lorenzo make the choice he made at the beginning the chapter.

WEEK 7 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Showdown in Paris

📖 Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→ INTRO

When you think of Paris, what image comes to mind? For most people, it is the Eiffel Tower. But did you know that many people were against the building of the Eiffel Tower and many obstacles almost prevented the Eiffel Tower from being built. This book will tell that story. It also tells the story about what life was like at the end of the 19th century and introduces us to people from around the world. A list of the people mentioned in this book are listed on p. ix-xi. It might helpful to look back at it as you read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.Begin Ch.1, p.1-19 (Read the narrative and skip blue pages) Beginning- "terrible for an artist!"

2.(Optional) Blue pages on p.4-5

- Why do you think it was important for the French to build something taller than the Americans?

→ VIEW

1.This 555-foot stone pillar was the tallest human-made structure at the time.

∞ Image Link: Washington Monument

2. You can view a few of the paintings of James McNeill Whistler, the American painter based in England, known for post-impressionism.

∞ Link: Paintings of James McNeill Whistler

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the incident mentioned at the top of p.11 that talks about James Bennett drunken behavior.

• DEFINITIONS

uncouth: behaving in a rude way
: not polite or socially acceptable

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

WEEK 8 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- 1.p.19-37 "France was counting" -
- 2.(Optional) Blue pages on p.

- Why do you think world fairs were such an important event, especially in that time period?

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 9 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- 1.p.37-58
 - 2.(Optional) Blue pages on p.
- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 10 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- 1.p.59-81
- 2.(Optional) Blue pages on p.

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image



Term 2

WEEK 11

30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.82-104

2.(Optional) Blue pages on p.

• Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

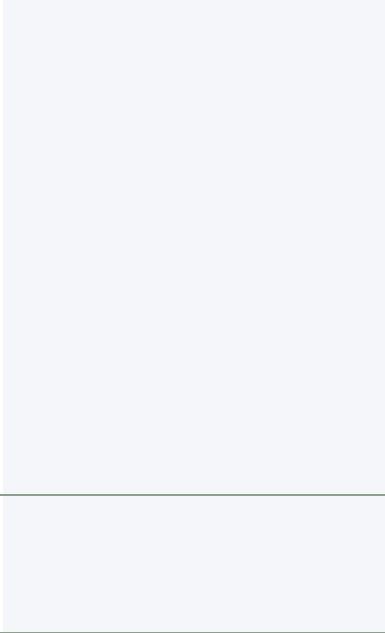
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WEEK 12

30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.

QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: EIFFEL'S TOWER FOR YOUNG PEOPLE



World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.106-124

2.(Optional) Blue pages on p.

• Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 2 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.124-145

2.(Optional) Blue pages on p.

• Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 3 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.147-174

2.(Optional) Blue pages on p.

• Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 4 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.177-195

2.(Optional) Blue pages on p.

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 5 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.195-217 (end)

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 6 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.219-245

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 7 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.245-268

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 3

WEEK 8 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO
Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.269-285
• Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 9 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO
Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.287-305 (whole)
• Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 10 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO
Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.307-325
• Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 11 30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Eiffel's Tower for Young People

→RECAP

→ INTRO
Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

World History: Grades 7-8

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Term 3	
p.326-346 • Discussion Question Idea → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 12  30m World History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36	